upon its conclusion. He then introduced me to the president and commended the long-standing relationship between the two countries, which was guided by the Mossad on the Israeli side.

The prime minister spoke at length about the situation in the Middle East and his efforts to promote peace between Israel and its neighbors. He delved into details regarding Israel's relations with each state—Egypt, Jordan, Syria, and the Palestinians. He praised Morocco for its instrumental role in advancing peace in the region and expressed his hope that Indonesia would also contribute to the advancement of peace. Suharto responded by saying, "Here we are, meeting, and it will soon be known to the world!"

The two discussed China. Rabin told Suharto about his visit, his meetings and impressions, and the two agreed that China would be a major player on the global level and certainly in East and Southeast Asia.

Suharto and Rabin were both people who spoke in understatement, but as a listener on the sidelines one could sense that as the diplomatic process in the Middle East progressed, progress could also be expected in the relations between Indonesia and Israel.

The meeting lasted about an hour and a half. At its conclusion, gifts were exchanged. Photographers came into the room to take pictures, and my photograph, God help us, also appeared in all the Jakarta newspapers the next day. The president escorted us to the exit, and the convoy set out for the airport, where our next mission awaited us—arriving in Singapore before the start of the Sabbath.

Until the Khomeini revolution in 1979, Israel had "contact" with the Persian Gulf from southern Iran. This contact enabled us to get a closer feel of Iraq as well as at least some of the Gulf States. It was only natural for us to aspire to develop contacts in the southern part of the Gulf also, across the Straits of Hormuz. The Sultanate of Oman, strategically located opposite and south of the Hormuz bays (i.e., at the entrance to the Gulf from the Indian Ocean), had a long tradition of British influence, in the form of a protectorate. In 1932, Said bin Taimur came to power as sultan, with the support of the British. He was deposed in 1970 by his son, Sultan Qaboos bin Said, who remains the country's leader to this day. Oman has an area of 212,000 square kilometers, with a population of less than a million people. The sultan comes from the Ibadi tribe, the largest of the various groups in the sultanate. The tribe originates from the Khawarij (who were the first to secede from the original Islam). Beginning in the eighth century they have